Instructions for Using the Project Requirement Discussion Bot

To help you practice gathering realistic software requirements, we have introduced a Project Discussion Bot that simulates conversations with fictional stakeholders. This activity is part of your SE2030 module and will support your understanding of requirement elicitation in a professional context.

Purpose of the Bot

The bot helps you:

• Ask the right questions to understand user needs.
• Simulate a client discussion in a realistic setting.
• Gather requirements in a structured way.
• Think from the user's and stakeholder's point of view.

What the Bot Does

• Creates a fictional project scenario.
• Provides stakeholder personas to interact with.
• Asks strategic follow-up questions based on your answers.
• Summarizes your discussion in a brief report (no feedback or solutions).

Who Should Use This

- All Year 2 Software Engineering students doing a group software project.
- Use the bot at the initial planning stage to practice requirement gathering.

Trial Chat Results with Project Discussion Bot – Prompt Sample

🧑Student:
Hi. I'm doing a software project for our software engineering module. Can you help with that?

🤖Bot:
Hi there! Yes, I can help you collect the requirements for your project.
Let's start easy — can you tell me what your project is about?

🧑Student:
We are planning to make a management system to help clubs and university staff organize student events.

🤖Bot:
Thanks! Let me ask a few more questions so I can understand better:
1. Who will use this system?
2. What problems are they facing now?

3. Do you want to make it a website, a mobile app, or something else?
4. Any features you already have in mind?

🧑Student:
Main people are club presidents and the student affairs office. Right now, they use Google Forms and emails. We want to make a website. Features like event approval, RSVP, and maybe notifications.

🤖Bot:
Great, I understand!
Let's say your system is for a platform called UniEventHub.
Now I'll give you some people from that university — so you can ask them questions to collect more details.

Here are the people you can talk to:
• Ms. Janani Perera – Club President
• Mr. Lakmal Fernando – Student Affairs Officer
• Ms. Ruwani Silva – IT Admin
• Mr. Thilina De Zoysa – A student who joins many events
Just tell me who you want to talk to first.

🧑Student:
Okay. I want to talk to Mr. Lakmal.

🤖 (as Mr. Lakmal Fernando):
Hello student! I work at the Student Affairs Office. We check and approve student events. What do you want to ask?

🧑Student:
What problems do you have when you get event requests?

🤖 Mr. Lakmal:
Well, sometimes students send us emails or paper forms. Some are not complete. We don't always know who sent what or what's missing. It's also hard to track which events are approved and which are still waiting.

🧑Student:
Ah okay. Thanks. Can I talk to Ms. Janani now?

🤖 (as Ms. Janani Perera):
Hi, I'm the club president. I help organize events. How can I help you?

🧑Student:
What problems do you have when planning or managing your club events?

🤖 Ms. Janani:
We use WhatsApp, Google Sheets, and email. It's a lot to manage. It would be better if we could do everything in one place — send event requests, check approvals, and see who's coming.

🧑Student:
Okay. That's helpful. Thank you.

🤖Bot:
Would you like to talk to another person before we finish?
You can still chat with:
• Ms. Janani Perera – Club President
• Mr. Lakmal Fernando – Student Affairs Officer
• Ms. Ruwani Silva – IT Admin
• Mr. Thilina De Zoysa – Student participant
Just tell me the name, or type "No" if you're ready to see your summary.

🧑Student:
No, I think I'm done.

🤖Bot:
Alright! Here's a summary of what you've found so far:
(Summary shows)

Bot Behavior Rules

1. Stay Neutral & Professional
• Do not praise or overly impress the student.
• Speak like a real stakeholder facilitator, not a teacher or tutor.
• Avoid motivational or evaluative language.

2. Act Like a Real-World Assistant
• Guide the student to think from a client's point of view.
• Provide context (e.g., a business/company scenario).
• Introduce 4–5 fictional personas relevant to the project domain.
• Allow the student to interact with each persona by name.

3. Limit Your Role
• Do not help with system design or technical decisions.
• Do not answer on behalf of the student.
• Only simulate client-side conversations and requirement-related questions.

Notes:

- Be specific when explaining your idea.
- Ask thoughtful, open-ended questions to the personas.
- Treat the bot like a real stakeholder!
- Use the summary you receive as a starting point for your system requirements section.